

Lesson 5: INTRODUCTION TO BASIC CSS

Course: Web Development Basics

Grade Level: Beginners (Age 10+ or adult learners)

Duration: 45–60 minutes

Lesson Number: Day 4

Topic: Basic CSS (Inline, Internal & External)

1. Learning Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will be able to:

- Explain what CSS is and why we use it
- Apply **inline CSS** to style specific elements
- Apply **internal CSS** using the <style> tag
- Understand the purpose of **external CSS**
- Use basic CSS properties like color, font-size, background-color, text-align, and font-family

2. Materials Required

- Computer / Laptop
- Online HTML Editors / IDEs:
 - Replit (<https://replit.com>)
 - CodePen (<https://codepen.io>)
 - JSFiddle (<https://jsfiddle.net>)
 - W3Schools Tryit Editor (<https://www.w3schools.com/html/tryit.asp>)
- Slides (optional)

- Teacher's notes & sample code

3. Lesson Overview (Teacher Notes)

This lesson teaches the **basics of CSS styling** and the **three ways to apply CSS**.

Focus only on simple, visual CSS so students stay confident:

- Color
- Background color
- Font size
- Font family
- Text alignment

Avoid borders, margins, padding, and layout concepts until the next class.

4. Lesson Breakdown

➤ 4.1 Warm-Up (5 minutes)

Share the screen with two HTML pages:

- One plain page (only text)
- One styled page (colors, font size, background)

Ask students:

- What do you notice?
- Which page looks better and why?
- How do you think we can add these changes?
- Why do you think styling is important in websites?

➤ 4.2 What is CSS (3 minutes)

CSS = Cascading Style Sheets

CSS is used to style and decorate HTML pages.

Examples:

- Colors
- Font styles
- Backgrounds
- Text alignment

➤ 4.3 Inline CSS (10 minutes)

Let the learner type and run the code

```
<h1 style="color: blue;">Welcome to My Website</h1>
```

```
<p style="font-size: 20px; text-align: center;">
```

This is my first styled paragraph!

```
</p>
```

Explain:

- Inline CSS is written **inside the HTML tag**
- `style=" "` contains the properties

Ask students to:

- Change color
- Change font-size
- Change text alignment

➤ 4.4 Internal CSS (10 minutes)

Let the learner to type and run the code

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
```

```
<html>
```

```
<head>
```

```
<style>
```

```
h1 {  
  color: purple;  
  text-align: center;  
}  
  
p {  
  font-family: Arial;  
  font-size: 18px;  
}  
  
</style>  
</head>  
  
<body>  
  
<h1>My Styled Page</h1>  
  
<p>This text is styled using internal CSS.</p>  
  
</body>  
</html>
```

Explain:

- Styles are kept inside <style> in the <head>
- Cleaner than inline
- Easier to reuse

Ask students to:

- Change colors
- Change fonts
- Change paragraph size

➤ 4.5 External CSS (10 minutes)

Introduce ONLY the concept — keep it simple.

Show the file structure:

- index.html
- style.css

index.html

```
<html>
```

```
<head>
```

```
<link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
```

```
</head>
```

```
<body>
```

```
<h1>Hello World</h1>
```

```
<p>This is styled using an external stylesheet.</p>
```

```
</body>
```

```
</html>
```

Style.css

```
h1 {
```

```
  color: green;
```

```
}
```

```
p {
```

```
font-size: 18px;
```

```
}
```

Explain:

- External CSS is stored in a **separate CSS file**
- Best for big projects
- Most professional method

No need to create full, big examples—show the idea.

5. Hands-on Activity

Create a webpage titled **“My Styled Profile Page”**

Must include:

- One heading
- One paragraph
- Inline CSS once
- Internal CSS once
- Basic properties only:
 - ✓ color
 - ✓ font-size
 - ✓ background-color
 - ✓ text-align
 - ✓ font-family

Example expectations:

- Heading color changed
- Paragraph centered
- Background color added
- Font changed to Arial/Times New Roman

6. Assessment (Exit Ticket)

Ask students:

- What is CSS used for?
- Write one example of inline CSS.
- Where do we write internal CSS?
- What is the purpose of the external CSS file?
- Name two CSS properties used today.

7. Homework

Create a webpage titled **“My Favorite Place”**

Include:

- One heading styled with color
- One paragraph with font-size and font-family
- Inline CSS for one element
- Internal CSS for the rest
- Background color for the page